Samuel Leeming

+44 7925 844944 | samjleeming@gmail.com | Derby, UK | Full UK Driving Licence | Open to Relocation

Personal

A highly driven and inquisitive Medicinal and Pharmaceutical Chemistry student at Loughborough University, on track to achieve a 2:1. Demonstrated aptitude for synthetic, analytical and computational chemistry, with a particular interest in the design and development of therapeutically relevant compounds. Proven ability to work efficiently under pressure, both independently and as part of a team, across academic, research and professional settings. Has a passion to contribute positively to colleagues and teams, with a strong work ethic and genuine enthusiasm for tackling complex industrial challenges. Looking for a graduate position in medicinal or synthetic chemistry in the pharmaceutical industry.

Education

Loughborough University Sept 2023 - Jun 2027 (Expected)

MChem Medicinal and Pharmaceutical Chemistry | Predicted Classification: 2:1

- Final Year Dissertation: Investigating new opioid alternatives for analgesia, involving emerging analgesic mechanisms and non-opioid analgesic targets.
- Relevant modules include: Pharmacokinetics & Drug Metabolism, Modern Aspects of Organic Chemistry, Pharmaceutical and Biomedical Analysis, Current Trends in Inorganic Chemistry, Science Communication, Energy, Molecules and Applications, Investigative Projects for Medicinal Chemists, Fundamental Synthetic Chemistry, Structural Characterisation, Spectroscopy and Analysis, Principles of Biological Chemistry, and Computer Programming.

Bilborough College Sept 2021 - Jun 2023

A-Levels

- Chemistry: A | Mathematics: B | Biology: B
- Cambridge Chemistry Challenge: Silver Award - a competitive national chemistry competition for Sixth Form students in the UK.

West Park School Sept 2016 - Jun 2021

GCSEs

- 11 GCSEs including Mathematics, Sciences and French.

Research Experience

Undergraduate Research Intern - Loughborough University Jul 2026 - Sep 2026

Department of Chemistry | Supervised by Dr S. E. Bodman | Funded by the Leverhulme Trust

- Designed and synthesised a set of new π-extended porphyrins and lanthanide (Eu) complexes for potential applications in photodynamic therapy (PDT).
- Conducted inert atmosphere synthesis using Schlenk line techniques, developing practical skills in handling air/moisture-sensitive compounds.
- Characterised target compounds using NMR spectroscopy, UV-Vis absorption, fluorescence spectroscopy, mass spectrometry, X-ray crystallography and column chromatography.
- Worked collaboratively alongside PhD and PDRA researchers, gaining first-hand experience to a professional academic research environment.
- Collected and processed experimental data, prepared figures and authored a comprehensive written research report summarising findings and their implications for future work.

Work Experience

Crew Member - McDonald's Apr 2022 - Present

- Delivered high-quality customer service in a high-pressure environment, consistently maintaining quality and efficiency during peak periods.
- Demonstrated strong reliability and commitment over four years of continued employment alongside full-time education.
- Collaborated effectively within a large team, developing communication, adaptability and problem-solving skills under time constraints.

- Adhered to strict food safety, hygiene and operational standards in a regulated working environment.

Skills

Laboratory Skills

- Proficient across a broad range of undergraduate-level laboratory disciplines: synthetic, organic, inorganic, analytical, computational and biological chemistry.
- Practical techniques: NMR spectroscopy, HPLC, IR spectroscopy, UV-Vis and fluorescence spectroscopy, mass spectrometry, column and flash chromatography, Schlenk line / inert atmosphere synthesis.

Software & Computing

- ChemDraw (molecular structure and reaction drawing), Microsoft Office Suite (Word, Excel, PowerPoint).
- ORCA quantum chemistry software operated via command line terminal for computational modelling tasks.
- Familiarity with AI-assisted research and analytical workflows.

Achievements and Extracurricular Activities

- Rugby - Loughborough University Hall Team (2024-25): Represented hall in inter-hall competitive rugby, developing teamwork, discipline and commitment outside of academic study.
- Cambridge Chemistry Challenge - Silver Award (2023): A nationally recognised competition that identifies high-achieving chemistry students at Sixth Form level.

References available upon request